Riverside County Market Intelligence

CRMLS residential, January 2024 – June 2026 — what a frozen market costs the buyer, and who sells it now.

EMORY WILLIAMS · IDX EXCHANGE DATA ANALYST INTERNSHIP · SUMMER 2026

$600K	**$321**	**34 days**	**98.0%**
median close price — unchanged 2024, 2025, and 2026 H1	median price per sq ft — unchanged all three years	days on market, 2026 H1 — IQR-filtered avg (31 in 2024)	sale-to-ask, 2026 H1 — IQR-filtered avg (98.6% in 2024)

This report connects two things: what it costs a family to buy a home in Riverside County, and who profits from selling it. Prices have been frozen for two and a half years, mortgage rates never left the 6–7% band — and the squeeze that puts on buyers is redrawing the industry that sells to them.

MARKET OVERVIEW — THE BUYER'S MATH

The median sale — the middle home, half sold for more and half for less — closed at exactly **$600,000** in 2024, in 2025, and again through June 2026 (price per square foot likewise frozen at **$321**; fewer than 2% of sales land exactly at $600,000 — a real plateau, not a mix shift or rounding quirk). For the buyer, frozen does not mean affordable: with 20% down at the period's average 6.58% mortgage rate, that median home costs about **$3,060 a month** before taxes and insurance — roughly $1.58 million over the life of the loan. A family that waited the entire thirty months for relief got **$48 a month** of it — all from rates (6.64%→6.49%), none from price. Homes also sell about 10% slower (**34 days**, up from 31).

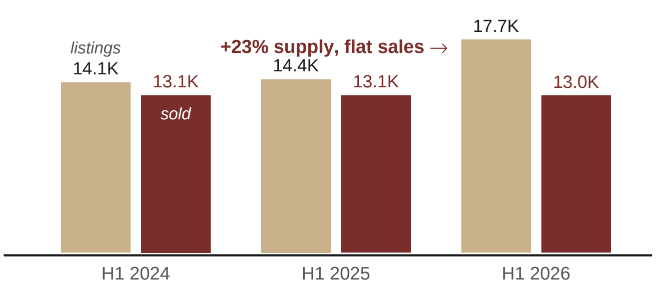
PRICING TRENDS

The sale-to-ask ratio compares what a home sold for against what the seller asked. At today's **98.0%**, buyers pay about $98,000 per $100,000 of asking price — down from $98,600 in 2024. On the median home that is roughly **$12,000 negotiated off** — so far, the only relief buyers have actually won. Sellers concede in negotiation; they do not cut the asking price.

MARKET ACTIVITY

Why didn't 6%+ mortgages pull prices down? Scarcity. In 2024–25, barely more homes were listed than sold (about 1.05 per sale) — with so little to choose from, buyers absorbed the full cost of high rates and prices never budged. Early 2026 is the first crack: homes *put up for sale* jumped to **17,691 (+23%)** while purchases stayed flat (13,065 → 13,053 → 13,047). Inventory is finally building, and choice is the first leverage buyers have been handed in this window.

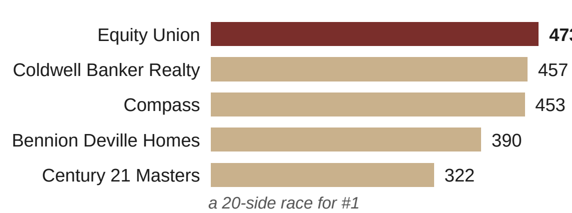
New listings vs. closed sales, Jan–Jun of each year



COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Every sale credits one office as the seller's representative — a "listing side," the scoreboard of this business. By that score a Southern California independent, **Equity Union**, now runs the county's **#1 office**, twenty sides ahead of national names Coldwell Banker Realty and Compass; Keller Williams slipped to **4.9%** of sides and **Opendoor** — the app that bought homes for cash — has nearly left (0.8%→**0.2%**). The consumer squeeze and this reshuffle are connected: across California, low-fee and virtual brokerages are growing fastest exactly where affordability bites hardest — doubling their share in affordable-tier counties like Riverside while barely moving in premium ones — and almost no top agents switch firms (21 of 500 one year, 16 of 495 the next). Cost-pressed sellers changing whom they hire, not agent poaching, is what is moving market share (statewide figures from the same data; see footnote).

Closed sides, 2026 H1 — top offices



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **The buyer paid for the freeze:** the frozen $600,000 median at stuck 6–7% rates means about $3,060/month — and 30 months of waiting delivered just $48/month of relief, none of it from price.
- **Scarcity did the squeezing:** in 2024–25 only ~1.05 homes were listed per home sold, so high rates never forced prices down — buyers absorbed the entire cost.
- **2026 is the first crack:** listings jumped 23% against flat sales; buyers finally gain choice, and about $12,000 of negotiating room on the median home.
- **The squeeze is redrawing the industry:** a local independent now edges the national brands for #1 in Riverside, low-fee brokerages are doubling share where affordability is tightest, and the cash-offer app is gone (0.8%→0.2%).
- **What to watch:** if supply keeps outrunning sales, buyer relief should show up first in sale-to-ask, and only later in the $600K median itself.

CRMLS closed residential sales, Riverside County, Jan 2024 – Jun 2026. Payment math: 20% down, principal and interest only, national average 30-yr fixed rate (FRED) joined to each month; no taxes, insurance, or PMI. Brokerage business-model labels reflect the firms' public descriptions; commission data is outside this dataset. Supply–sales comparisons are Jan–Jun of each year (like-for-like; no annualization anywhere). 255 placeholder records excluded from rankings; sale-to-ask guarded to (0,2]; DOM and sale-to-ask tiles are IQR-filtered averages, price tiles are all-rows medians. Statewide figures (Compass volume, producer-switch counts, tier shares) are computed from the same statewide CRMLS extract with the same rules — no external sources. Dashboards: public.tableau.com/app/profile/emory.williams · Code: github.com/jackemorywilliams-bit/idx-exchange-su26